dissent among the Arab armies and would prevent them from acting as a single unified force, something that Israel would successfully exploit.

Just a few hours after the declaration of the creation of the State of Israel, four Arab armies from Egypt, Syria, Jordan, and Iraq launched a simultaneous invasion of Palestine (Lebanon, which had originally also been expected to take part in the invasion, played virtually no role in the war that followed, allegedly as a result of a large bribe paid by Israel). In addition to the 10,000 men of the Arab Legion, these armies included around 10,000 soldiers from Egypt, 3,000 from Iraq, and 3,000 from Syria, all supported by tanks and combat aircraft. The First Arab-Israeli War had begun.